CS571 Spring 2025 – ICA K

User Evaluation

Please *make a copy* of this document by clicking **File > Make a copy**. You may share and co-edit it with your fellow group members.

In this in-class activity, you will explore the concept of **User Evaluation** by designing and executing a usability test to evaluate on one of your past HWS (1-11) in three steps:

1. Prepare the Usability Test
2. Execute the Test Plan
3. Analyzing and Report Findings

Areas needing your response are clearly marked with **Your Turn!** Be sure to complete all aspects of the assignment. Your Canvas submission will be a **pdf** version of this document.

<u>You may complete this in groups of 1, 2, or 3 people! :)</u> Please be sure to assign yourself and your team member(s) to a group.

1. Prepare the Usability Test

In this part, you will develop a brief *formative* usability test plan by defining and characterizing three dimensions: ***why, how,*** and ***what***.

Your Turn! Design a usability test to evaluate one of your group's HWs (1-11) by using the criteria below.

For this usability test, we will be evaluating BadgerChat.

1. ***Why:*** Define the test goal by identifying two desired outcomes for your study. You can choose from the five Es, the three dimensions of the ISO definition of usability, or related concepts or outcomes (e.g., desirability, learnability, discoverability) that best fit what you would like to evaluate.

    - Outcome 1:
    - Outcome 2:

2. ***How:*** Determine the measurements you will use for the testing. You should consider metrics/measures from both qualitative and quantitative.

    - Qualitative:
    - Quantitative:

3. ***What:*** Based on the outcomes, define 2 *scenarios* that will guide your usability test. Make sure that your scenarios are *goal-oriented, contextual,* and *task-specific*. For each scenario, explicitly state which *outcome* you are attempting to evaluate.

    - Scenario 1:
    - Scenario 2:

2. Execute the Test Plan

In this part, you will execute the test plan you just made. To do this, you will identify two volunteers to help you test your product. These could be classmates, friends, or family members. However, they ***cannot*** be yourself or someone from your own group. If we have time during class, you may turn to groups around you!

You can capture measures in real-time or perform this later by recording the sessions (with the participant's consent). If you are using self-report measures, be sure to provide the participant with a paper or electronic copy.

During and following the test, be sure to make qualitative observations by asking questions, e.g., "You seemed surprised by that response, what were you expecting?" where appropriate.

Your Turn! Conduct your usability study and report your findings below. This should include your raw data and observations. This will be later organized in the next step.

3. Analyzing and Report Findings

Finally, you will analyze your results and translate them into design insight.

- For your *quantitative* data, calculate averages, variances, or other relevant statistics from your metrics and report your findings.
- For your *qualitative* data, categorize your notes and observations into a minimum of two high-level findings. Affinity diagramming may be helpful for this!

If the quantitative data or the qualitative comments from your two participants vary significantly, you can also comment on these differing views.

Your Turn! Report your findings in narrative form and end your report with high-level design insight and recommendations for how your agent might be improved.

1. **Quantitative Summary**

   <Calculate averages, variances, or other relevant statistics and summarize>

2. **Qualitative Summary**

   <Categorize your notes and report a minimum of two findings>

3. **Conclusions**

   <Report high-level insight and recommendations for how to improve the project>

After completing this document, please be sure to upload it as a PDF in Canvas!